Japanese Language Society



Seventh Meeting | 7回目の対面

Agenda

- Important Verb Forms
  - ～たい form
  - ～たり form
  - ～ば form
  - ～たら form
- Ways to list nouns
- と
- Question words



PART I: Desire Form

~たい

Desire Form ~たい

- The ~たい form is a versatile verb form used to describe something you want to do.

たべたい

- I want to eat.
- If you want to conjugate a godan verb into the ~たい form, then you first turn it into its “root form” (the ます form without the ます) and simply attach the ~たい)

はし
走る → 走ります → 走り
＋たい = 走りたい

- I want to run.

- You shouldn’t use たい to describe what others want because it could come off as rude and assuming.

PART II: Listing Form

～たり

Listing Form / ～たり

- ～たり is a verb conjugation that creates a non-exhaustive list of actions, states, or examples.

  休(やす)みの日(ひ)には、テレビを見(み)たり、寝(ね)たりする。

- “On days off, [I] do things like watching TV and sleeping.”

- ～たり conjugates like the て form:

  打(う)つ→ 打って → 打ったり

- Things like hitting.

PART III: How to list nouns

と/か/とか/や

How to list nouns

- と creates an exhaustive list.
- リンゴとオレンジがある。
- “There’s apples and oranges (only apples and oranges).”

- か behaves like “or”.

みず　かじゅう

- 水か果汁がほしい。
- “[I] want (either) water or juice.”

How to list nouns continued

- とか creates a non-exhaustive list while meaning “for example” (NOTE: とか has to be placed after every noun).
- ハイキングとかバックパッキングとかができる
  キャンプに行きます。
- “[I’m] going to a camp that has stuff like hiking and backpacking.”

- や also creates a non-exhaustive list. The difference between や and とか is that や means “A, B, and others” while とか means “things like A and B.”

  しろ　　はな
- 白やピンクの花がある。
- “There are pink and white flowers (and other colored flowers).

PART IV: Conditional Form ～ば

条件形「～ば」

Conditional Form ~ば

- The ば form is similar to the English “if”.
- To conjugate:
  - **Ichidan:** drop the る, then add **~れば**
  - **Godan:** keep the root, change う ending syllable to an え ending one and add **~ば**
- Examples:

食べれば

書けば

- IF you eat
- IF you write

じかん　　つく

時間があれば、クッキーを作るよ

If [I] have time, [I will] make cookies.

- ~ば is one the more formal conditional forms in Japanese.

PART V: Conditional Form ~たら

条件形「~たら」

Conditional Form ~たら

- The ~たら form is used for conditional statements but can also mean “when” or “after” in some contexts.
- たら is more casual and used more often in day-to-day speech.
- If you want to conjugated into the ~たら form, you need to first put the verb into the past tense and then add ら.

たべる → たべた → たべたら

EXAMPLES

かね　りゅうがく
お金があったら留学するのに。

If [I] had money, [I would’ve] studied abroad.

べんきょう　つか
勉強をしたら、疲れた。

After [I] studied, [I] became tired.

そつぎょう　りゅうがく
卒業したら、留学する。

When [I] graduate, [I will] study abroad.

PART VI: Conditional と

と

Conditional と

- と as a particle can be used to indicate a strong, unquestionable causal relationship between two phrases.

- Basically:

If X happens, then Y happens

この番号に電話をかけると、警察が来る。

If [you] call this number, the police will come.

PART VII: Question words

疑問詞

Question Words

- 何
  - なに or なん if followed by a sound from the だ line.
  - Means “what”
  - 夕飯は何がいい？
    - What do you want for dinner?
- 誰
  - だれ
  - Means “who”
  - 誰から電話がありましたか？
    - Who called you?
- どこ
  - Means “where”
  - 病院はどこですか？
    - Where is the hospital？
- いつ
  - Means “when”
  - 誕生日はいつですか？
    - When is your birthday？

Question Words continued

- Adding “か” turns question words into indefinite pronouns.
- なにか (or なんか) = something
- 誰か = someone
- どこか = somewhere
- いつか = sometime

- Adding “も” turns question words into negative pronouns.
- なにも = nothing
- 誰も = no one
- どこも = nowhere
- いつも = actually means “always”!
  - いつもサッカーしている。
  - [I’m] always playing soccer.

Thank you!

ありがとうございます